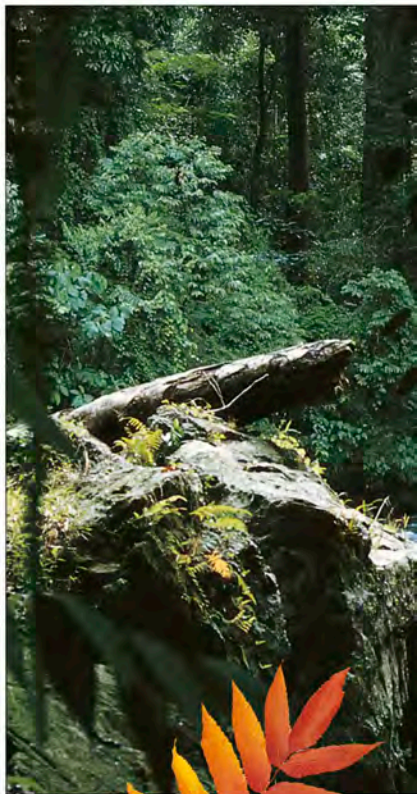


PLANT LIFE

Plants grow everywhere, from the icy Arctic to the tropics—any place where there is air, light, and water.

In deserts, where it rarely rains, plants have to save moisture. Some, like cacti, have pleated stems that expand to store water when there is a shower. Where the climate is hot and humid, plants grow very quickly all year round to make lush rainforests. In temperate places—where it is not too hot and not too cold, with a medium amount of rain—most plants flower and fruit in summer, but may lose their leaves or stop growing in winter. Plants usually grow in soil, but some absorb what they need directly from the water. Without plants, our world would be very different; from plants we get food, clothes, paper, and lots of other things. Most important of all, they provide oxygen, which all living creatures need to breathe.



Water
hyacinth



The growth of a blackberry from flower to fruit



Stag's horn
sumach